

Educational Guide: Advisory Pricing Models & Proposal Templates

This document breaks down the core templates available for advisory engagements, outlining their unique benefits and practical applications to help streamline your scoping, pricing, and client onboarding processes.

1. Advisory Pricing Model (Spreadsheet)

- **Benefits:** This comprehensive model removes the guesswork from pricing by providing pre-calculated bundled options, content suggestions, and a "Blank Team" matrix. It breaks down complex jobs into manageable components (e.g., scoping, research, presentation, implementation) and allows you to easily calculate fees based on the specific team members assigned to each task. It also includes a highly detailed Due Diligence Scoping Model for mergers or acquisitions.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Provides complete transparency regarding what they are paying for. When you present pricing based on this model, the owner clearly sees the breakdown of tasks, timelines, and the specific objectives of the work being performed.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Protects the firm's profitability. By inputting specific hourly rates for travel, preparation, and advisory time across different team members, the advisor ensures that every hour is accounted for. It prevents scope creep and allows the advisor to clearly distinguish between chargeable discovery/scoping work and non-chargeable proposal presentation time.
- **Who it is suitable for:** Best suited for firms utilizing multiple team members on a single project, and for complex, bespoke advisory engagements—especially due diligence or structural reviews.

2. General Advisory Proposal (Slide Deck)

- **Benefits:** A structured framework designed to convert the findings of a discovery meeting into a compelling, logical pitch. It visually connects the client's "End Game" to the specific actions required to get there.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It explicitly focuses on *their* stated objectives and what is currently holding them back (Legitimate Constraints). Importantly, it outlines exactly how many hours of the *client's* time (or their staff's time) will be required to execute the recommendations, setting clear expectations from day one.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It provides a professional, easy-to-follow narrative structure that justifies the requested financial investment. It also features a built-in "Variation to Scope of Works" template to handle future out-of-scope requests.
- **Who it is suitable for:** Ideal for clients requiring bespoke, customized consulting tailored to their specific, unique business problems.

3. Lite Fundamentals Proposal (Slide Deck)

- **Benefits:** This template offers a pre-campaigned, "out-of-the-box" advisory program. It divides the advisory journey into three highly digestible pillars: Getting More Organised, Getting More Work, and Doing More Profitable Work.
 - **How it helps the Business Owner:** It demystifies business growth by providing a clear, educational curriculum. Owners learn fundamentals like the working capital cycle, the 4 levels of consumer awareness, and process improvement cycles.
 - **How it helps the Advisor:** It is highly scalable and efficient. The proposal uses a merge table, meaning the advisor can quickly input data to auto-populate the document rather than writing it from scratch.
 - **Who it is suitable for:** Best for smaller businesses or clients who need foundational business coaching and structured systems rather than highly complex, customized interventions.
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Practical Application: Step-by-Step Method

Step 1: Conduct Discovery & Scoping Begin by holding a discovery session to understand the client's needs. If the needs are complex (e.g., a formal risk management review or a merger), use the **Advisory Pricing Model** to flush out the tasks required. Use the "Blank Team Pricing Matrix" to input your staff's names and their respective travel, prep, and advisory rates.

Step 2: Allocate Time and Calculate Fees Within the pricing model, break the project into components (Introduction, Scoping, Research, Presentation, Implementation, Review). Assign the appropriate team member to each task and allocate the hours. Keep in mind that while discovery and research might be chargeable, the proposal presentation itself is generally not.

Step 3: Select and Draft the Proposal

- If the engagement is highly customized, open the **General Advisory Proposal**. List the client's Business Objectives and Constraints. In the "Recommendations" section, detail the steps to win and *crucially*, list the hours the client must commit to the process.
- If the client simply needs foundational help, open the **Lite Fundamentals Proposal**. Navigate to the merge table in the portal and enter the required data to automatically populate the proposal's fields.

Step 4: Present and Manage the Engagement Present the proposal, clearly outlining the monthly investment and the total fee. Once signed, if the client later requests assistance with an unquoted issue (like financing new equipment), immediately use the **Variation to Scope of Works** document

included at the end of the templates. Document the new issue, the timeline, and the extra estimated fee (e.g., 14 hours for \$3,700) and have them sign it before commencing the extra work.

Common Q&A

Q1: Where do I input my firm's specific hourly rates?

A: You must enter your staff names and their varying rates (travel, prep, advisory) into the "Blank Team Pricing Matrix" tab of the Advisory Pricing Model before using the calculation sheets.

Q2: Should I charge the client for the time it takes to present the proposal?

A: Generally, the presentation is not charged to the client. However, depending on the complexity, you may charge for the scoping, discovery, and research analysis phases that lead up to the proposal.

Q3: In the General Advisory Proposal's "Recommendations" section, whose hours are supposed to be listed?

A: The hours listed there are strictly for the *client* or their staff. It is designed to show them how much of their own time they must commit to make the project a success.

Q4: How do I easily fill out the Lite Fundamentals Proposal?

A: The Lite Fundamentals Proposal is driven by a merge table tool in the advisor portal. You enter the data into the tool, and it automatically inserts the values into the document.

Q5: What do I do if a client asks for extra work after the original proposal is signed?

A: Both proposal templates include a "Variation to Scope of Works" document. You should use this to formally outline the newly identified opportunity, the timeline, and the additional estimated fee required before beginning the work.

Document Sources Summary

Template Name	Core Focus & Contents
Advisory Pricing Model	A comprehensive spreadsheet featuring bundled content suggestions, a blank team pricing matrix to assign staff rates to specific tasks, and a highly detailed Due Diligence Scoping Model covering structural, asset, and staff reviews.
General Advisory Proposal	A slide deck for pitching bespoke advisory services. It structures the narrative around discovery findings, detailing business objectives, legitimate constraints, recommended actions (with the client's required time commitment), and the financial investment.
Lite Fundamentals Proposal	A structured, easily generated slide deck for a foundational advisory program. It focuses on standard business education pillars: Getting More Organised, Getting More Work, and Doing More Profitable Work.
Pricing & Proposal Tutorial	A video transcript guiding users through the software portal, explaining how to populate the pricing matrix, how to use the automated merge table for the Lite proposal, and differentiating chargeable versus non-chargeable project phases.

Advisory Scoping & Proposal Logic Tree

Logic Branch	IF (Condition / Trigger)	THEN (Action / Next Step)	Additional Context / Notes
Branch 1: Bespoke Consulting	IF the client has unique, specific business problems identified during a discovery meeting...	THEN utilize the "Advisory Pricing Model" to map out the bespoke tasks and present the "General Advisory Proposal".	Ensure you explicitly list the hours the client must commit in the Recommendations slide.
Branch 2: Foundational Coaching	IF the client requires general business education, better systems, or foundational marketing/sales planning...	THEN utilize the merge table tool to quickly generate the "Lite Fundamentals Proposal".	Focus on pitching the three pillars: Organised, More Work, Profitable Work.
Branch 3: Business Acquisition / Merger	IF the client is looking to purchase another entity or merge operations...	THEN utilize the "Due Diligence Scoping Model" within the Advisory Pricing spreadsheet.	Systematically review and price tasks like Asset Utilisation, Staff Contracts, and Supplier Risk.

Branch 4: Out-of-Scope Requests	IF the client requests assistance with a new project (e.g., bank finance applications) after the initial agreement...	THEN immediately generate a "Variation to Scope of Works" document.	Clearly state the new issue, timeline, and the additional estimated fee required, and obtain a signature before proceeding.
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